

Learning Intention: I can use apostrophes to show missing letters in contractions and to show ownership (possession).

Success Criteria — I can:

- Identify contractions and know which letters are missing.
- Use an apostrophe to show singular possession.
- Use an apostrophe to show plural possession.

Strategy Box — Two Jobs of an Apostrophe

Job 1: Contractions	Job 2: Possession
Replaces missing letters when two words join into one (e.g. do not → don't).	Shows that something belongs to someone (e.g. the dog's bone = the bone belongs to the dog).

Model — Contractions

Two words	Contraction	Missing letters
do not	don't	o
is not	isn't	o
I am	I'm	a
they are	they're	a

The apostrophe sits exactly where the missing letter(s) used to be.

Model — Singular vs Plural Possession

Singular (one owner): the cat's toy — apostrophe before the s.

Plural (more than one owner): the cats' toys — apostrophe after the s.

Ask yourself: how many owners are there? One owner → 's. More than one owner → s'.

Identify — Find the Apostrophes

Read the sentences below. Circle each apostrophe, then write whether it shows a **contraction** or **possession**.

Sentence	Contraction or Possession?
Ruby's kite got stuck in the tall tree.	
We can't find the missing library book.	
The players' jerseys were hanging on the fence.	

Parent Tip

Spot apostrophes together when reading anything at home — a menu, a sign, a book. Ask "Is that showing something is missing, or that something belongs to someone?"

Key Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
Contraction	Two words joined into one, with an apostrophe replacing missing letters
Possession	Showing that something belongs to someone or something
Singular / Plural	Singular means one; plural means more than one

Manipulate & Apply — Practise using apostrophes correctly.

Q1 — Write the Contraction

Two words	Contraction
has not	
we are	
I will	
did not	

Q2 — Fix the Sentence

Add the missing apostrophe in the correct place.

- a) Im going to the beach on Saturday. → _____
 b) The teachers desk was covered in books. (one teacher) → _____
 c) Theyre bringing their bikes to the park. → _____

Q3 — Singular or Plural Possession?

Write the correctly punctuated possessive form for each.

Owner(s)	Item	Correct possessive form
one dog	lead	
three dogs	leads	
one student	desk	
all the students (whole class)	desks	

Q4 — Choose the Correct Word

Circle the correct word in each sentence.

- a) The dog wagged (its / it's) tail happily.
 b) (Its / It's) going to rain later today.
 c) The bird built (its / it's) nest in the old oak tree.

Watch Out!

Its (no apostrophe) shows possession — "the dog wagged its tail". **It's** (with apostrophe) is short for "it is" or "it has". This is one of the trickiest apostrophe rules — there is no apostrophe in the possessive "its", even though most other possessives use one!

Q5 — True or False?

Statement	True / False
"Banana's" is the correct way to write more than one banana.	True / False
"They're" is a contraction of "they are".	True / False

Create & Challenge — Explain your thinking and write your own.

- 1 Explain:** What is the difference between "the dog's bone" and "the dogs' bone"?

- 2 Explain:** Why doesn't "its" (showing possession) have an apostrophe, even though most other possessives do?

- 3 Create:** Write three of your own original sentences:

1. A sentence using a **contraction**: _____
2. A sentence using **singular possession**: _____
3. A sentence using **plural possession**: _____

Quick Check — Exit Ticket

Write the contraction for "should not", and explain in one sentence what it shows.

Answer & Teacher Support**Answer Key — Pages 1 & 2**

Identify (p1): Ruby's — possession. can't — contraction. players' — possession (plural).

Q1 (p2): hasn't, we're, I'll, didn't.

Q2 (p2): a) I'm going to the beach on Saturday. b) The teacher's desk was covered in books. c) They're bringing their bikes to the park.

Q3 (p2): dog's lead; dogs' leads; student's desk; students' desks.

Q4 (p2): a) its. b) It's. c) its.

Q5 (p2): "Banana's for plural" — False (should be "bananas", no apostrophe needed). "They're = they are" — True.

Answer Key — Page 3

Q1: "The dog's bone" means one dog owns the bone. "The dogs' bone" means more than one dog shares/owns the bone.

Q2: "Its" is an exception to the usual possessive rule — it never takes an apostrophe when showing possession, to avoid confusion with "it's" (it is/it has).

Q3 (acceptable-answer guide): Accept any three original, grammatically correct sentences that clearly demonstrate a contraction, singular possession, and plural possession.

Exit ticket: shouldn't - the apostrophe replaces the missing letter "o" in "not". It is a contraction of "should not".

Teacher Checklist

- ☐ Identifies contractions and the missing letters they replace.
- ☐ Correctly punctuates singular possession.
- ☐ Correctly punctuates plural possession.
- ☐ Distinguishes "its" from "it's" correctly.
- ☐ Recognises that ordinary plurals never take an apostrophe.
- ☐ Writes original sentences correctly demonstrating both apostrophe uses.

Teacher Tip

The its/it's distinction is the single most common apostrophe error at this level — give it extra practice time. Also watch for students adding apostrophes to ordinary plurals (e.g. "banana's" for more than one banana), which is a very common overgeneralisation.